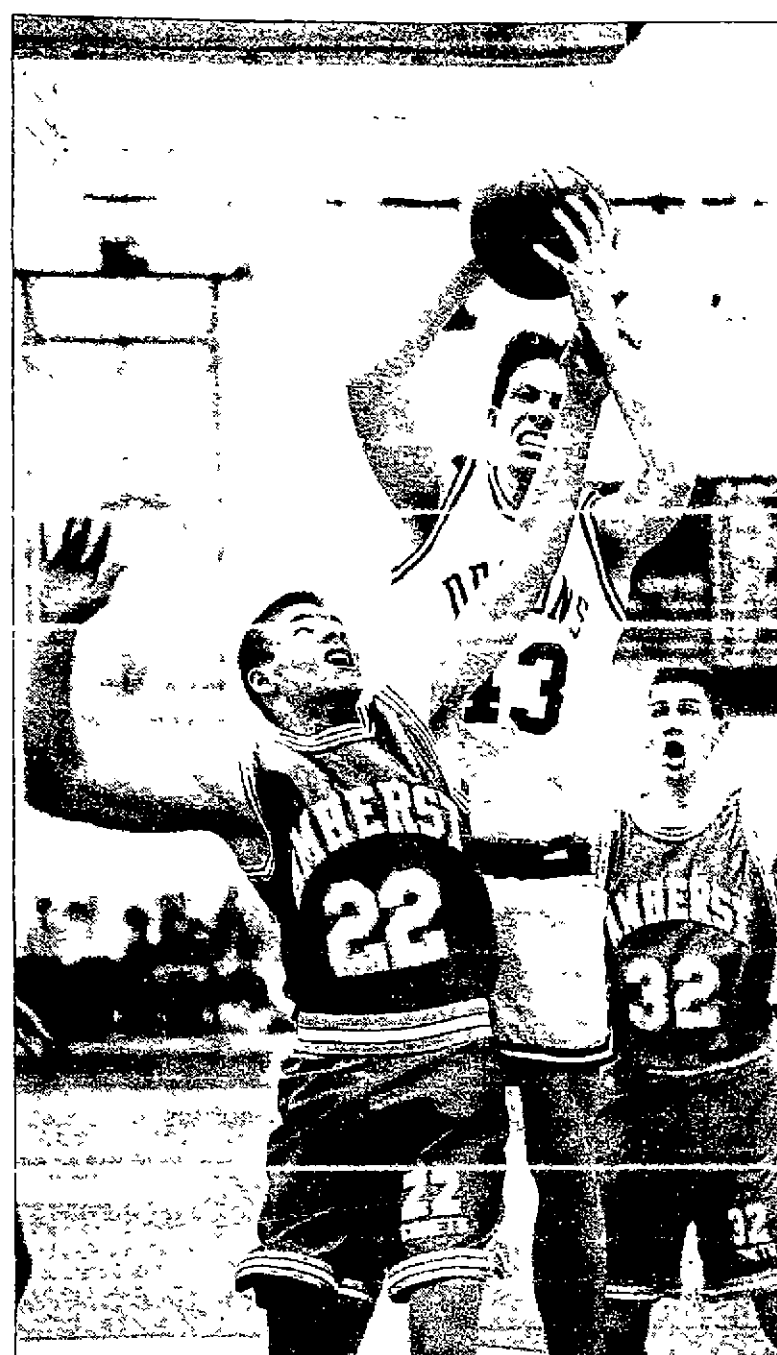


Stingy Westlake refuses to share SWC title



LINDA MURPHY/CHRONICLE

HOLDING Amherst's Todd Damasiewicz (22) has a firm hold on the situation—the arm of Westlake's Jon Meyer—but the 6 foot 6 Demon got the rebound anyway.

SOUTHWESTERN CONFERENCE ROUNDUP

Deasy's big play wins OT thriller

Avon Lake49 OT
Rocky River45

AVON LAKE— Sean Deasy's four-point play in overtime helped lift Avon Lake to victory over Rocky River in the regular season finale.

With two minutes remaining in overtime, Deasy was fouled while making a 3-point basket, and added the foul shot to put the game out of reach for the Pirates (3-11, 7-13).

Avon Lake (10-10, 6-8) was led in scoring by Deasy and Tom Koprowski, who totalled ten points each. Nebojsa Kesic led the Pirates with 16.

In tourney play next week, Avon Lake opens on Thursday in the Division II at Berea against Brookside. Rocky River faces Cleveland Rhodes in the first game of the same night at Berea.

R.R.	G	F	T	A.L.	G	F	T
Striding	5	0	12	Deasy	3	1	10
Cramer	2	0	4	Mimsay	3	2	8
Lehto	5	3	13	Fitz	1	0	3
Kesic	7	2	16	Hrbancik	3	1	8
				Port	3	0	3
				Krivak	2	6	10
				Ugo	3	0	5
				Candice	0	1	1
Totals	19	5	45	Totals	18	11	49

Three-point goals: Rocky River, Standing 2; Avon Lake 3, Fitz, Hrbancik, Port.
Junior varsity: Avon Lake, 45-37

Olmsted Falls.....74
Fairview.....59

FAIRVIEW PARK— Matt Tabar scored 27 points to lead Olmsted Falls to a regular season ending victory over Fairview.

Tim Schaefer added 18 for the Bulldogs, who raised their record

to 14-6 overall (8-6 SWC). The Warriors, led by Paul Kerrigan's 24 points, dropped to 10-10, 4-10.

Olmsted Falls begins tourney play in the Division II at Berea next Saturday at 6:30 p.m., against the winner of the Wednesday Firelands-Brecksville game.

OLMSTED FALLS (7-4), Deasy 3, Matis 7, Tabar 27, Moore 4, Storey 4, Johnson 2, Steppentbacker 4, Neumeister 2, Schaefer 18.
FAIRVIEW (5-9), Chambers 2, Malesko 8, Cook 3, Kerrigan 24. Smith 12, G. Neal, Fortinor 2.

O.F.	G	F	T	Fair	G	F	T
Chambers	2	0	4	Chambers	2	0	4
Malesko	8	1	15	Malesko	8	1	15
Cook	3	0	8	Cook	3	0	8
Kerrigan	24	3	13	Kerrigan	24	3	13
Totals	15	10	19	Totals	15	10	19

Three-point goals: n/a
Junior varsity: Olmsted Falls, 41-33

North Olmsted.....53
Bay46

BAY VILLAGE— Nine 3-point baskets were not enough for the Rockets as North Olmsted outlasted Bay in Southwestern Conference play.

Steve Gdovin and Keith Bielezer scored 16 and 15 points, respectively for the Eagles, who closed the regular season at 11-9 (7-7 SWC). Bay, led by Mike Masterson with 20 points, dipped to 10-9 (6-8 SWC).

North Olmsted enters Division I tourney play next Tuesday at 7:30 p.m., against Lakewood St. Edward at Midview High. Bay plays in Division II at Berea on Tuesday at 6:30 p.m., against Fairview.

N.O.	G	F	T	Bay	G	F	T
Berard	1	3	5	Maslin	1	0	3
Bielezer	4	5	15	Gurney	2	0	3
Fing	0	1	1	Moson	6	1	20
Smith	6	0	12	Scott	1	2	5
Sulzer	2	0	4	Miler	3	0	9
Gdovin	5	8	18	Glen	2	0	4
Totals	18	16	53	Totals	17	3	46

Three-point goals: North Olmsted, Bielezer 3; Bay 9. Miler 3, Masterson 3, Gurney, Maslin, Scott.
Junior varsity: won by Bay

HIGH SCHOOL NOTEBOOK

FAN SUPPORT was given major credit by Elyria High's basketball players for the Pioneers' performance Friday night when they beat Sandusky to move into a tie for first place in the Erie Shore Conference.

"We had a pizza party after the game and all the players agreed that the cheers of the fans were an important factor in their winning the game," a mother of one of the players told The Chronicle. "They hope the fans continue this Friday night for the Lorain game."

JUST AS the two schools finished the football season with an important contest, so will the basketball squads from Elyria and Lorain. One big difference, however, Both teams know this will be the final time they'll square off on the court (unless they happen to meet in the Midview District tournament).

"We're just happy to be in it," said Mike Walsh, coach of the Pioneers. "The Elyria-Lorain rivalry has been unbelievable and its gone back a long ways."

I'm glad the last Elyria-Lorain game is not one that everyone comes just to see who wins it but that it will be for something." The two schools are tied with Sandusky for the Erie Shore lead and the winner will do no worse than tie for the conference championship.

"This is their (Lorain) last game, period," said Walsh. "I'm sure they're really looking forward to it. I just hope both teams go out and play very well."

CHECK OUT the socks! Coach Mike Walsh has insisted all year that his team not wear black socks as part of its uniform apparel but Saturday night at Southview, the whole team had them on.

"After Friday's win, I gave in and bought the whole team a pair for this game (Southview)," said Walsh.

Walsh himself must have checked out the tie section. He had a sharp black "Mickey Mouse" tie on for the contest Saturday.

Demons' defense ruins Amherst hopes

Jerry Rombach
The Chronicle-Telegram

WESTLAKE— Maybe Westlake's boys basketball team should change its nickname from Demons to Scrooges.

You know, as in stingy. Westlake already had the Southwestern Conference championship wrapped up going into Friday's game with visiting Westlake, the only league foe with a chance to share the trophy.

But no way was Coach Art Daniels and his players in any mood to share that championship. The Demons came from behind to end Amherst's co-title hopes, 56-51, before a jammed Westlake gym crowd and Channel 25 television cameras.

The Demons changed from share-minded hosts to Scrooges in a nearly four-minute stretch of the last 1:29 of the third period to the first 2:14 of the fourth.

Amherst had beaten Westlake in the first meeting, 49-47, of the teams on Jan. 28. And with 1:29 left in the third the Demons looked like they might do it again.

Enter the Scrooges. Westlake scored 14 straight points to go from a 35-31 deficit to

Westlake	G	F	T	Amherst	G	F	T
Hannan	4	14	34	Morar's	4	0	14
Hack	5	2	14	Nixon	4	0	10
Fisher	6	1	13	Cline	3	2	9
Faber	1	0	2	Staback	3	0	8
Compton	1	0	2	May	2	0	6
Meyer	1	0	2	Daub	1	0	2
Westfall	0	0	0	Draga	1	0	2
Houser	0	0	0	White	0	0	0
				Dusho	0	0	0
				asewicz	0	0	0
				Roh	0	0	0
				Burke	0	0	0
Totals	23	8	56	Totals	15	7	51

a 45-35 lead. The lead increased to 12 points, 51-39, before Amherst finally settled down, regained its composure and battled back. But it was too late, the Demons getting no closer than three points with :28 left, 54-51.

The Demons' spurt came with a rat trap press and then halfcourt man-to-man defense that forced Amherst into five straight scoreless possessions. During that stretch it had three straight shots blocked.

Offensively, Westlake for the first time started getting the ball inside to its big man, 6 foot 8 Bret Fisher, who got ten points in the

surge that produced a 19-4 scoring advantage before the Demons finally failed to tally after nine straight possessions. He scored only three points the other 28 minutes of the game.

"Fisher really stepped it up in the last half," Daniels said. "The kids got him the ball. He also played well on defense."

"Somehow I just got some open shots," Fisher said. "I don't know if they relaxed or what, but they got away from their zone and I was one-on-one."

One of the baskets was a slam dunk. Only seconds earlier he had the same chance but scored on the conventional layup.

"I was more wide open on the second so I immediately thought of stuffing it," he said. "It was fun. They always are."

Amherst Coach Dave Zavara was proud of his team.

"Take away that little spurt and maybe we would have won it," he said. "Suddenly they got the ball inside to Fisher, and that controlled the middle. They also controlled the boards in that period. But we recovered and had a nice effort at the end. We just ran out of time."

Daniels added, "All year we

talked about the same thing, that it all starts with defense. Our full court pressure may not look like it's working at first, but it wears on a team, giving them tired legs. That's why we usually make late runs. It just doesn't happen, we make it happen."

This was Westlake's 11th conference championship of the modern era since World War II, the last one in 1992 when it had to share the title with Amherst. The Demons also won in 1979, 78, 75, 74, 73, 64, 63, and 55. Six were solo titles, five shared.

Westlake shot 46 per cent from the field, had 15 turnovers and a 32-26 edge in rebounds. Amherst hit 39 per cent from the field and had 13 turnovers.

The Demons finished the regular season at 17-3, with a 12-2 league mark and will carry a five-game winning streak into next Friday's Midview Division I Tournament opener against the survivor of Tuesday's North Olmsted-Lakewood St. Edward game.

Amherst's four-game win streak ended Friday, dropping the Demons to 13-7 overall and 10-4 in the league. They will open Division I tourney play Monday at Midview against Elyria.

Midview's seniors have some fun

Jim Jablonski
The Chronicle-Telegram

GRAFTON — Senior Nights are about feeling good — and that was the case in Grafton Friday, as long as you were a Middle fan.

Midview held on at the end to defeat the visiting Vermilion Sailors, 56-52, to finish fourth in the Erie Shore Conference with a 9-5 record. The Middies concluded the regular season at 14-6.

Along the way, Anthony Stacey, the area's scoring leader, finished with 27 points. That figure included three first half power slams, just enough to keep the fans into the game. Stacey's total gave him 601 points on the 20 game season, for a 30.1 average.

"It was a nice way to end the season," said Middle coach Ray Verba. "We won the game and the seniors played and held up very well while the superstar got several jams. It was just enough to

Midview	G	F	T	Vermilion	G	F	T
Young	0	0	0	Sheets	2	0	4
Miller	1	3	5	Czyrak	2	2	8
Hoffman	1	0	2	Staback	3	0	6
Elbert	5	1	11	Parmenter	9	0	19
Stacey	12	2	27	Holla	5	0	11
Joan	0	2	2	Schmid	0	0	0
Gault	0	0	0	Deane	2	0	4
Mosby	4	1	9	Bartlett	0	0	0
Totals	23	5	55	Totals	24	2	52

Three-point goals: Midview-Arthur Stacey; Vermilion-Ian Hollis, Chris Parmenter.
Junior varsity: Vermilion, 46-41

keep everybody happy."

Everybody but Vermilion coach Bob Walsh, of course. "I'm still waiting for my team to show up, they haven't arrived yet," Walsh joked bitterly after his team fell to 10-10 on the season, 6-8 in the ESC.

"We got totally out-hustled," Walsh continued. "They (the Middies) got every loose ball tonight. I don't know why, you'll have to ask them (the Sailors)."

ERIE SHORE CONFERENCE ROUNDUP

Sandusky coasts to title sharing victory

Sandusky83
Southview.....45

SANDUSKY— Sandusky cruised past visiting Southview Friday night to clinch a share of the Erie Shore Conference title with Elyria.

Sandusky (14-6, 11-3) forced 31 Saint turnovers while forging leads of 28-8 after the first quarter and 51-17 at the half. The Streaks were led on offense by DeMar Moore's 19 points. Southview (2-18, 2-12) received ten points each from Dan Teitelbaum and David Calez.

Sand.	G	F	T	Sand.	G	F	T
Gracioso	3	0	6	Moore	7	3	19
Melendez	0	2	2	Aaron	3	0	6
Tibbans	5	0	10	Minnid	3	0	6
Fagan	2	0	4	Rifson	3	0	6
Calez	5	0	10	Brown	3	0	6
He	1	2	4	Cooper	0	0	0
Wargo	1	1	3	Fidgens	2	0	5
Lane	3	0	6	Chinichir	1	5	7
				Paugnot	1	1	3
				Forster	0	2	2
				Jones	3	0	7
Totals	20	5	45	Totals	31	15	83

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Sand 29 22 7 25 — 83
Southview 10 10 18 14 — 45

Three-point goals: Sandusky, none
Southview 3, Moore 2, Pickens
Junior varsity: Sandusky, 56-38

Southview opens Division I tourney play Monday at Midview against Admiral King at 6 p.m.

Admiral King78
North Ridgeville.....44

LORAIN— After a lackluster first half, Admiral King reeled-off 50 points in the third and fourth quarters to rip Ridgeville in the conference finale for both teams.

Rashad Hannibal led the Admirals (10-10, 7-7) with 19 points. The Rangers (1-19, 0-14) received 11 points from Jesse Whitlock.

North Ridgeville opens Division I tourney play Tuesday against Midview on the Middies' court at 6 p.m. King starts Division I action Monday at 6 p.m., at Midview against Southview.

N.R.	G	F	T	A.K.	G	F	T
McNamara	2	1	7	Scott	0	2	2
Whitlock	4	2	11	Arroyo	1	1	3
Johnson	0	6	6	Davis	2	0	4
Vandell	1	0	2	Crotti	1	2	4
Whalen	1	2	4	Hannibal	9	0	19
Elliott	1	2	4	Trance	4	0	9
Sparrow	1	1	3	Taylor	4	1	11
				Whitfield	1	2	5
				Kates	2	3	15
				On	1	0	2
				Plavsek	2	0	4
Totals	11	16	41	Totals	31	13	78

Three-point goals: North Ridgeville 3, McNamara 2, Whitlock, Admiral King 3, Hannibal, Torrence, Whitfield.
Junior varsity: Ridgeville, 47-46

LORAIN COUNTY CONFERENCE ROUNDUP

Clippers, Wildcats tie for second

Clearview.....70
Keystone.....48

LORAIN— Robert Russell led four Clearview scorers in double figures as the Clippers downed Keystone, tying the Wildcats for second place in the Lorain County Conference on the last day of the regular season.

Russell finished with 18 points for the Clippers (10-10, 9-5). Jason Rodak scored 19 points to lead the Wildcats (12-8, 9-5).

Clearview starts tourney action in Division III at Elyria Monday at 7 p.m., against Elyria Catholic. Keystone gets underway in post-season play in Division II at Berea next Saturday against the winner of Tuesday's Bay-Fairview game.

Klone	G	F	T	Clview	G	F	T
Halling	4	1	10	Pedraza	4	2	11
Johnson	0	1	1	Dower	4	4	14
Kalauer	1	1	3	Alecson	2	4	8
Babb	1	3	6	Reafrin	3	4	12
Stewart	1	1	3	Reafrin	7	4	18
Kinect	1	0	3	Gibert	3	1	7
Rodak	6	8	19				
Totals	14	14	48	Totals	24	19	70

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Clview 12 6 13 17 — 48
Keystone 18 9 15 25 — 70

Three-point goals: Keystone 6, Halbo 3, Babb.

Kinect, Rodak, Clearview 3, Ronnie Russell 2.
Pedraza
Junior varsity: won by Keystone.

Avon82
Firelands.....69

HENRIETTA— Steven Vega and Josh Guerrieri combined for 45 points to lead Avon past faltering Firelands in Lorain County Conference action Friday.

Vega, the Eagles' freshman point guard, scored 15 of his 23 points at the foul line, where Avon (5-14, 3-11) outscored the Falcons, 29-2.

Joe Potts led Firelands (7-12, 6-8) with 25 points, including five of the Falcons' 11 three-point baskets.

Both teams go into tourney action next week, Firelands in Division II at Berea Wednesday at 8 p.m. against Brecksville, Avon in Division IV at Strongsville Wednesday at 6:30 against Independence.

Avon	G	F	T	Fire	G	F	T
Jones	1	2	4	Potts	10	0	25
Guerrieri	6	6	22	Allopp	2	0	5
Vega	4	15	23	Pitts	1	0	3
Quislar	1	2	5	Collier	5	1	12
Hayden	2	2	8	Thirby	3	0	7

EC athletic director Mark McGuire. In his 40 years coaching the frosh, Rotunda had a won-lost record of 419-223, and had only four losing seasons. Lou remains active at EC as an assistant athletic director and student counselor.

Benson 5 0 10 Vmell 5 0 14
Pogoda 1 0 2 Spenza 1 1 3
Totals 25 20 82 Totals